Operations Fundamentals · Module 2

Out of your head.

About 45 minutes, then the stranger test, then four weeks of leaving it alone. Have your module 1 map beside you.

1
Map and write the task that breaks.

2
Have someone new follow it once.

3
Hand it over, with a decision and a limit.

4
Check the four basics for everyone.

You're off for two weeks. What breaks?

The task only you know how to do. This is the one you work on.

Step 1a · map it before you write it

Trigger, handoffs, record

Trigger

The event that starts it. Not 'monthly'.

Handoffs

Every point it changes hands: who → who.

Record

The proof it happened, and where it lives.

Example, Kestrel invoicing: client signs off the event → account manager → founder → client → invoice in the client folder, tracker says Invoiced.

Step 1b · about 20 minutes

Write it: the nine questions

Steps last. If you can answer a question without thinking about your own business, you haven't answered it yet. The full template and worked example are in the SOP guide.

1 **What starts it?**
An event, not a timeframe.

2 **Why does it exist?**
What it costs the business when it goes wrong.

3 **What does it cover, and not?**
Point to who handles the edges.

4 **Who owns it, does it, signs it off?**
One name for each.

5 **What does done well look like?**
Numbers, not adjectives.

6 **What do you need before you start?**
The actual system, folder or template.

7 **Which steps would someone get wrong?**
Only those. Verb first. Say why.

8 **What can they decide, and when do they stop?**
Decide alone up to… Stop and ask when…

9 **How do we know it happened?**
The record, and the next review date.

Step 2 · the stranger test

Someone new follows it once

Watch them do it without helping. Every question is a gap. Every skipped step needs a reason. Every hesitation needs a name, a number or a link.

Tested by

Someone who has never done it.

Date

Where they got stuck, and what I changed

Step 4 · the people basics

Four basics, for everyone

Name	Written contract	Right to work checked	Payroll and pension	Their role in one line
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	
	Yes · No	Yes · No	Yes · No	

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Step 3 · hand it over

The handover

Handing over to

Name and role.

Locked in on

Four weeks from now. Put it in your diary.

1 · The real example I'll show them

A live one, with at least one decision in it. Think out loud.

2 · Their teach-back

What they'd change · what they'd test first · where they still need me.

3 · Who checks, who fixes, who decides

Does it	Checks it	Fixes it	Decides	Told

4 · They decide alone

What, and up to what limit.

They stop and ask when

What triggers it → who they ask → how fast.

What are you still deciding that someone else could?